

AUSTIN PATEREK

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Creative Strategist // Creative Producer // Experience & Franchise Development

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Creative strategist and producer with 14 years building original IP for audiences, across streaming and linear television, documentary film, branded content, and location-based experience. Trained in visual anthropology, which means the work starts with what people actually do rather than what a deck promises they will, then carries that research through concept, format, and delivery.

Creator and producer of original formats and franchises for partners including Major League Baseball, ESPN, Apple, Google Arts & Culture, Honda, Nutella, Warner Bros. Discovery, YouTube, and The Pokémon Company. Track record owning scope end to end: leading multidisciplinary creative teams, directing vendor and agency partners, holding budget and schedule, and protecting creative intent from first idea through final delivery.

Current focus is experience strategy and producing for live entertainment, museums, and location-based storytelling, with creative technology and interactive work in the mix.

EXPERIENCE

Kinda Sorta Almost

Founder, Producer

2023 - Present

- Founded an independent studio developing nonfiction franchises and experiential IP, moving original concepts off the screen and into physical space for partners including Major League Baseball, ESPN, and Apple.
- Own franchise strategy on every project: brand identity, narrative framework, and the full audience journey, from a first watch through live and location-based extensions of the same idea.
- Run the studio end to end: creative briefing, agency and partner coordination, budget oversight, workback scheduling, delivery, and legal and business affairs.
- Direct multidisciplinary creative teams, working alongside Oscar-winning producers and award-winning directors, and source, evaluate, and manage independent creative and technical vendors against deliverables, timelines, and contract terms.
- Develop scope documentation and production strategies for immersive experiences at the intersection of content, technology, and physical environment, identifying vendor requirements, resource needs, and production methods.

Picture Editor // Freelance

2019 - 2023

- Led post pipelines for streaming and linear series for Warner Bros. Discovery, The Pokémon Company, A+E Networks, and others. Recent credits include *Tournament of Champions* (Food Network) and *Baylen Out Loud* (TLC).
- Operated as de facto post producer on most engagements: set the creative conventions a series would follow, then held to them across matrixed productions with multiple executive stakeholders, standards and practices, and legal review.
- Built the milestone tracking that kept delivery on schedule, and translated notes arriving from several directions into one coherent cut without losing the show's voice.
- Held brand tone under real constraint: compliance requirements, competing creative opinions, and fixed delivery dates.
- Member, Television Academy (Picture Editors).

Story Producer // Freelance

2016 - 2019

- Developed and produced documentary features and streaming series for major buyers and independent distribution, running development and production in parallel across several projects at once.
- Built the trackers, workback schedules, and deliverable matrices that kept each project visible and on time.
- Led cross-functional teams without formal authority, turning competing priorities from directors, editors, legal, and outside production partners into one direction a team could execute against on a fixed deadline.

Vernon Films

Head of Development 2016 - 2019

- Managed the slate for an award-winning documentary production company, moving franchise IP from first idea through pitch and commission, and guiding projects from blue sky through greenlight and into production.
- Built the case for each project: wrote and shaped the material, and worked out what a story could become across formats before it was ever greenlit.
- Pitched directly to major streamers and private equity firms, translating a creative idea into something a room of decision makers with competing priorities could say yes to.
- Built the documentation and milestone tracking that kept the full slate organized, and did the relationship work across the documentary and feature community that made each next project easier to get off the ground.

1stAveMachine

Creative Producer 2015

- Conceived and built the original content slate for the agency's new content division, owning creative development from concept through delivery.
- Wrote and pitched series concepts directly to YouTube Originals and other major platform buyers, building executive-ready presentations that turned complex IP into something a buyer could say yes to in one meeting.
- Delivered a multi-project engagement for the Google Arts & Culture team on schedule and under budget, including *Hyper History* as writer, creative producer, and creative director.
- Staffed and led cross-functional creative teams; owned budgets, payroll, and scheduling across concurrent projects, balancing creative ambition against delivery reality.
- Evaluated and managed vendor and talent relationships across production disciplines against quality, schedule, and delivery standards.
- Held agency, platform, and client decision makers aligned on one creative direction long before a frame got shot.

TV Producer // Freelance 2012 - 2015

- Managed editorial staffs and episode delivery for major linear networks, coordinating across executive producers, network clients, and post-production vendors to keep full seasons on schedule.
- Wrote original narration and story, and synthesized notes from stakeholders with conflicting priorities into finished episodes that still read as one voice.
- Worked on brand and identity development, keeping content and marketing aligned across studio, network, and outside agencies so the audience got a consistent read on a series everywhere they met it.

SKILLS

Experience Strategy · Franchise & IP Development · Format Creation · Brand Identity & Narrative Framework · Concept Development · Slate Management · Pitch & Executive Presentation · Creative Producing · Show Production Management · Budget & Schedule Ownership · Workback Scheduling · Scope & Change Management · Vendor Evaluation, Selection & Contract Management · Multi-Stakeholder Alignment · Legal & Business Affairs Coordination · Visual Anthropology & Ethnographic Method · Audience & Behavioral Research · Guest Experience Design · Placemaking · Immersive Storytelling · Location-Based Experience · Adobe Creative Suite · Avid Media Composer · Airtable · Asana

EDUCATION

University of South Carolina // BA Cultural Anthropology // Media Arts Minor

Focus in cultural anthropology and visual culture. Certified in human subject research. Published methods paper in an academic journal. Phi Beta Kappa, Magna cum Laude, Dean's List four years.

University of Manchester // MA Visual Anthropology

Focus in visual culture, placemaking, design, and aesthetics in the workplace. Lectured undergraduate courses. Dissertation selected for the Royal Anthropological Institute Library at the British Museum.

REFERENCES

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